

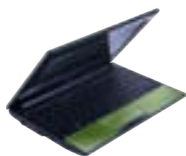


Netbooks

Netbooks have been around ever since ASUS launched the 7-inch Eee PC back in 2007. The word “netbook” was coined by Intel to promote a new platform aimed towards a new market segment wanting mini-laptops. These are extremely small, light and compact to carry around. Not great in terms of number-crunching performance but they offer 6-7 hours of battery life. Not bad for a sub-₹20k mobile PC right?

Since then and now, tablets are outselling and replacing netbooks as the fastest-growing consumer and personal technology segment. These tiny mini-laptops have come a long way. In such a short span of four years, Intel has rolled out several iterations of the Atom Pineview chipset – 45nm – while a 32nm update to Atom, code-named Cedar Trail, is scheduled for launch some time later next year.

Look forward to netbooks based on Intel’s Cedar Trail 32nm chipset with up to two cores, DDR3 RAM support, 1MB L2 cache, DirectX 10.1 support and clock frequencies of up to 2.13 GHz in the coming year. We have no doubt these hardware updates will help Intel and future netbooks tame the Internet, which has definitely been improved and refined since when netbooks first debuted back in 2007. Don’t rule out AMD just yet, they’re cooking upgrades to the existing Fusion APU (CPU + GPU on same silicon die) line to counter Intel’s strides in the 10-inch netbook and 12-inch thin-n-light laptop range. Who will win? The consumer, most definitely.



Acer Aspire One 522

Price: ₹18,203



ASUS Eee PC 1015PW

Price: ₹23,600



Cloud storage

Since netbooks have physical constraints and are meant to be low-priced, they’re seldom equipped with high-capacity hard drives. To negate that problem, ASUS offers free cloud-based storage of your data, up to 500 GB free for a year. All you need is a fast internet connection.



Designer netbook

The ASUS Eee PC 1008P Karim Rashid is unlike any other netbook you’ve seen. It dresses itself in a reptilian, crocodile-skin exterior that feels premium and quite exclusive. The designer surface extends from the screen lid to the bottom panel, ensuring the netbook is mistaken for a high-end designer accessory. Will make heads turn, let us assure you.

Zero1 Winner

Acer Aspire One 722

There weren’t a lot of netbooks, to be honest, as the category dipped on account of the tablet charge all over the world. Still, some OEMs did launch a few netbook offerings. Out of them, the best performing netbook we tested was the Acer Aspire One 722, sporting a 11.6-inch thin form factor and based on AMD’s Fusion chipset. Not only does the Aspire One 722’s AMD C-50 APU match up to Intel Atom’s CPU performance, but its onboard AMD Radeon HD 6250 DirectX 11 graphics ensures better graphics potential than any Intel Atom chip. Plus, the 11-inch netbook offers very good battery life – just over four hours. It is undoubtedly the best performance netbook of this year.

Worthy Mentions

Coming in behind, a close second and third would be the **Acer Aspire One 522** and **Asus Eee PC 1015PW**, respectively. Out of the two, the Acer Aspire One 522 is based on the AMD Fusion chipset while the Eee PC 1015PW has an Intel Atom chip inside. Both netbooks are very good for the price they’re sold at and a safe bet to go with if you can’t get your hands on the Acer Aspire One 722.

Acer Aspire One 722

Price: ₹18,999

